

RAISE THEM WELL

Brothers in Christ, It is a privilege to speak to you during this Men's Week. Today, I want to briefly address a topic of paramount importance: "Raise Them Well." As men of faith, we hold a profound responsibility in shaping the next generation. Our children are the future, and how we raise them will determine the kind of society we live in tomorrow. Reflecting on my own upbringing, I remember interpreting my dad's discipline as harshness or even wickedness. Yet today, I realize that his guidance, rooted in love and faith, is exactly how I aim to raise my own children to be disciplined and godly.

1. The Foundation of Faith:

Proverbs 22:6 tells us, "Train up a child in the way he should go; even when he is old he will not depart from it." The foundation of a godly upbringing begins with faith. Our primary duty is to instill in our children a deep and abiding love for God. This involves more than just bringing them to church; it means teaching them to pray, to read the Bible, and to live out the principles of Christ in their daily lives. When we model a life of faith and devotion, we provide them with a spiritual anchor that will guide them through the challenges of life.

2. The Balance of Love and Discipline:

Hebrews 12:11 reminds us, "No discipline seems pleasant at the time, but painful. Later on, however, it produces a harvest of righteousness and peace for those who have been trained by it." Discipline, when administered with love and wisdom, is essential for raising responsible and godly children. My own experience with my father's discipline, which I once viewed as harsh, has shown me that firm guidance is necessary for developing character and integrity. We must balance our discipline with love, ensuring that our children understand that our actions are motivated by our desire to see them grow into the people God intends them to be.

3. Teaching Responsibility and Integrity:

As fathers, we **must** teach our children the value of responsibility and integrity. Ephesians 6:4 advises, "Fathers, do not provoke your children to anger, but bring them up in the discipline and instruction of the Lord." This involves setting clear expectations, providing consistent consequences for actions, and encouraging them to take responsibility for their choices. Teaching integrity means being truthful, keeping promises, and showing respect for others. When our children see us living with honesty and integrity, they are more likely to adopt these values themselves.

4. Encouraging Empathy and Compassion:

In a world often marked by selfishness and indifference, raising children to be empathetic and compassionate is crucial. Colossians 3:12 urges us, "Therefore, as God's chosen people, holy and dearly loved, clothe yourselves with compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness, and patience." Encourage your children to understand and care about the feelings and needs of others. Involve them in acts of service and charity, teaching them the joy of giving and the importance of helping

those in need. Empathy and compassion will not only make them better individuals but will also contribute to a more caring and just society.

5. Fostering a Love for Learning and Growth:

Finally, we must foster a love for learning and personal growth in our children. Proverbs 4:7 says, "The beginning of wisdom is this: Get wisdom. Though it cost all you have, get understanding." Encourage curiosity, critical thinking, and a desire to learn new things. Support their educational endeavors and be involved in their academic lives. More importantly, teach them that learning is a lifelong journey and that growth often comes from challenges and failures.

Conclusion:

In conclusion, brothers, the task of raising our children well is both a privilege and a profound responsibility. By grounding them in faith, balancing love with discipline, teaching responsibility and integrity, encouraging empathy and compassion, and fostering a love for learning, we can guide them to become the disciplined and godly individuals that God calls them to be.

Let us embrace this role with dedication and prayer, knowing that with God's guidance, we can make a lasting impact on our children and, through them, on our society. May God grant us the wisdom, patience, and love to raise them well.

Thank you, and may God bless you all.